



JWT vs OAuth



Don't Confuse Them!

What is JWT?

Token Format (Digital ID)

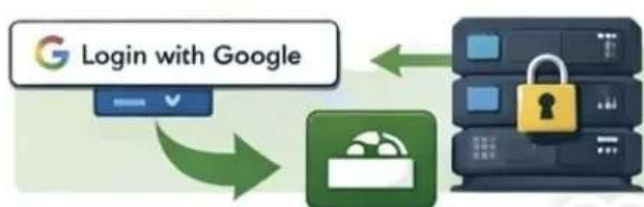
- User info in token
- Signed & Secure
- Sent with requests



What is OAuth?

Authorization Framework (Permission Grant)

- Access resources
- No passwords shared
- Uses access tokens



Key Differences

	JWT	OAuth
Type	Token Format	Authorization Framework
Purpose	Authentication	Autharication
Usage	User Identity	Resource Access
Dependency	Independent	Can Use JWT

Simple Analogy

JWT	OAuth
Your ID Card	Security Guard

When to Use What?

Use JWT	Use OAuth ⁶⁶
• Custom Auth • Stateless APIs	• Third-Party Login • Delegated Access

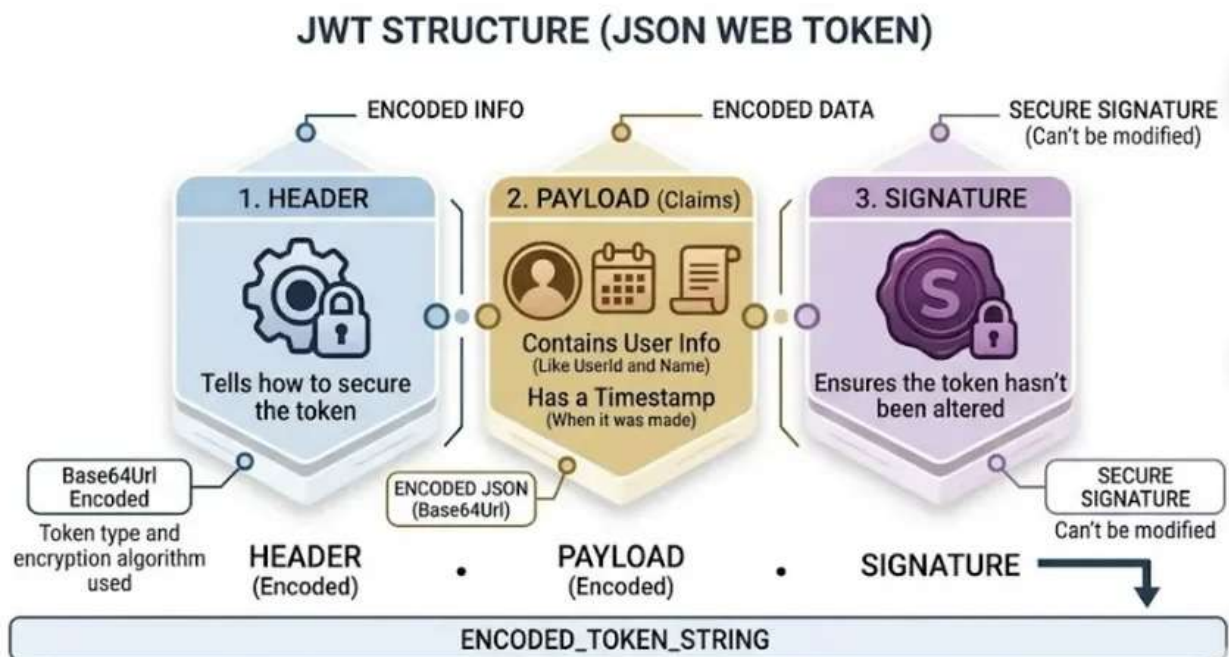
OAuth uses **JWT**, but **JWT** $\neq$ **OAuth**!

What is JWT?

JWT (JSON Web Token) is a token format.
Think of it like a digital ID card

Contains user information (claims)
Signed to prevent tampering
Sent with every request for authentication

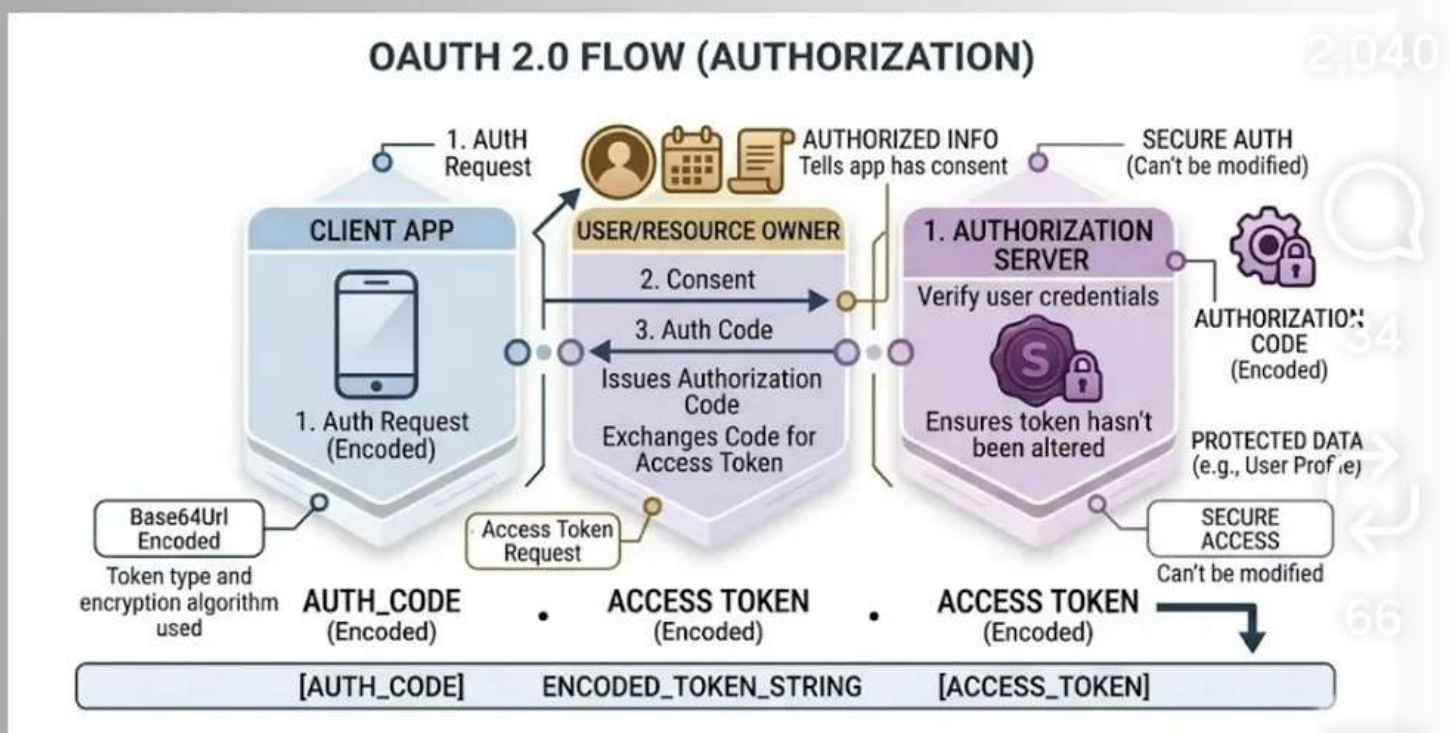
Example: When you log in → server gives you a JWT → you send it with every API call



What is OAuth?

- OAuth is an authorization framework.
- Think of it like a permission system
- Allows apps to access resources on behalf of a user Without sharing passwords.
- Uses access tokens (which can be JWTs)

Example: "Login with Google" That's OAuth in action



Simple Analogy

- JWT = Your ID Card
- OAuth = Security guard checking if you're allowed inside

When to Use What?

Use JWT when:

- Building your own authentication system
- Stateless APIs
- Microservices communication

Use OAuth when:

- Third-party login (Google, Facebook, etc.)
- Delegated access
- Enterprise-level security

- OAuth often uses JWT as the token format
- But JWT alone is NOT OAuth

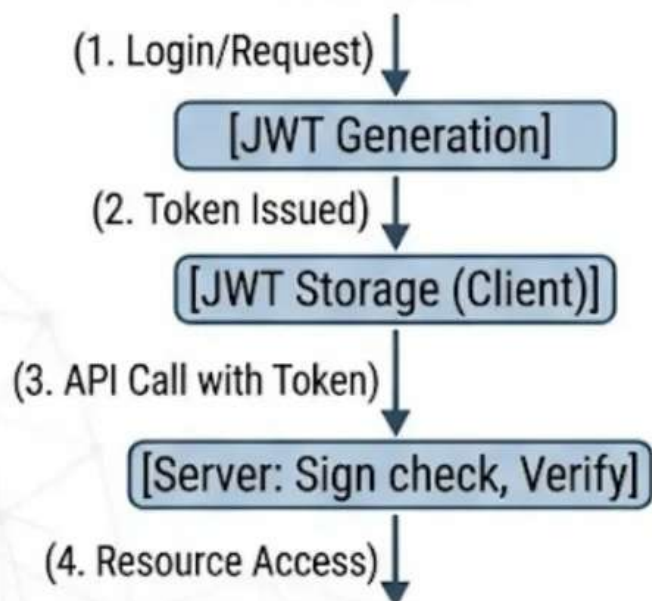
JWT vs OAuth: key differences

FEATURE COMPARISON

[Feature]	[JWT (JSON Web Token)]	[OAuth (Authorization)]
PURPOSE	Token for Auth/Data 	Protocol for Authorization
STATE	Stateless (self-contained) 	Stateful (requires session/token check) 
COMPONENTS	Header.Payload.Signature	Client, User, Auth/Resource Servers 
DATA CONTAINER	Yes (payload claims) 	No (carries authorization grant) 
VERIFICATION	Signature check 	Verification request to Server 
BEST FOR	Microservices, Stateless APIs 	User-Consent-Based Authorization 

FLOW SIMPLIFICATION

JWT FLOW



OAuth FLOW

